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CCIE Automation (v1.1) Equipment and Software List

🕒 May 20, 2026 Knowledge

• Posted by: Akhila Pamukuntla

CCIE Automation candidates should reference this v1.1 list for exams scheduled before March 23, 2027. Exams scheduled for March 23, 2027, and beyond should reference v1.2 list (<https://learningnetwork.cisco.com/s/article/CCIE-Automation-v1-2-Equipment-and-Software-List>).

The lab exam tests candidates on solutions that can be developed/configured using the listed equipment and software. Candidates may see more recent software versions during their attempt but will only be tested on features that are supported in the list below.

Passing the exam requires a depth of understanding difficult to obtain without hands-on experience. Early in your preparation you should arrange access to the listed equipment and software.

Virtual Machines

- Ubuntu Linux: 24.04 LTS
- IOSvL2: 15.2
- IOSv: 15.9
- Cisco Catalyst 8000V: 17.5
- Nexus 9300v (N9Kv): 9.3(8)
- Cisco Application Policy Infrastructure Controller 6.1 w/ ACI Simulator

Candidate Workstation

A virtual machine image (***OVA (<https://learningcontent.cisco.com/documents/CCIE-Automation-CWS.ova>)*** 8.6GB or ***qcow2 (<https://learningcontent.cisco.com/documents/CCIE-Automation-CWS-disk.qcow2>)*** 16GB) of the Candidate Workstation can be downloaded for use. The instructions to install it on vCenter are available for download at the bottom of the page. Image definitions for deploying it to CML can be found via ***the cml-community on Github (<https://github.com/CiscoDevNet/cml-community/tree/master/node-definitions/cisco/cws>)***. These assets are provided to assist candidates in preparing for the DevNet Expert Lab exam. They are provided without support or warranty from Cisco.

The candidate workstation is based on Ubuntu 24.04 LTS. Documentation for software will be supplied where available.

The following software is installed on the candidate workstation:

- Ubuntu 24.04 standard GNOME desktop
- Python 3.13.9
- Ansible Core 2.19.3
 - cisco.aci collection 2.12.0

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- PyCharm Community 2025
- Vim 9.1
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- Visual Studio Code 1.105

- Plugins:

- Docker
- HashiCorp Terraform
- Python
- Pylance
- Remote Development
- Remote – Containers
- Remote – SSH
- YAML
- Better Jinja
- XML Tools

- Google Chrome
- Docker 28.4.0 + compose plugin 2.39.4
- Terraform 1.13.3
 - ciscodvnet/aci v2.17.0
- Git 2.43
- kubectl 1.33
- telnet
- OpenSSH 9.6
- cURL 8.5
- wget 1.21
- netcat
- Bruno 2.13
- Wireshark 4.2
- OpenSSL 3.0
- Nginx 1.24
- Bash
- jq 1.7
- mllint
- direnv 2.32
- Cisco Network Services Orchestrator (NSO) local installation 6.5
- Cisco NSO IOS CLI NED 6.109.4
- Cisco NSO NX-OS CLI NED 5.27.3
- Cisco YANG Suite 3.0

Python Libraries / Packages

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The exam uses uv (<https://github.com/astral-sh/uv>) for management of Python virtual environments and dependencies. It is recommended to use it to create a virtual environment similar to the exam. Copy the **“pyproject.toml”** and **“uv.lock”** files into a directory and run: **uv sync --frozen** to create the virtual environment. An auto-generated **“requirements.txt”** is also provided for manual virtual environment creation without using uv.

Notes

- Dependencies were tested only on Ubuntu 24.04
- Candidates are not expected to know every single dependency provided in the file
- Additional Python development tools (such as ipython, ipdb, rich, etc.) are installed and available for candidates if needed. Check pyproject.toml to see what exact tools are available.
- Documentation for Python non-development dependencies listed in pyproject.toml will be provided.

Both the **“pyproject.toml”** and **“uv.lock”** as well as auto-generated **“requirements.txt”** files are available for download at the bottom of this article.

Other Third Party Software

- GitLab 18.4
- HashiCorp Vault 1.20
- Telegraf 1.36
- InfluxDB 3.4
- Grafana 12.2
- Kubernetes 1.33

Cloud

- Cisco AppDynamics
- Cisco ThousandEyes

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 **Files (3+)** (</s/relatedlist/ka0QO000000m0qXYAQ/AttachedContentDocuments>)

 **how-to-install-cws**
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 **taoluo31650** (</s/profile/0053i000000388U3AAI>)
April 12, 2026 at 11:46 AM (</s/feed/0D5QO000028UoeV0AS>)

Can anyone use ssh root@localhost to gain root privileges on the latest CWS ? I can't log in using the password 1234QWer!

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Bongani Bila (/s/profile/005QO00000E2t1xYAB)

Edited April 18, 2026 at 2:39 PM

ssh with "expert" then switch to root user:

ssh expert@localhost

su root

password# 1234QWer!

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Akhila Pamukuntla (/s/profile/0053i0000039domAAA)

February 27, 2026 at 9:13 PM (/s/feed/0D5QO00001yvHly0AE)

Hello everyone! The OVA and qcow2 files are uploaded!

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3 comments 196 views

OllieY (/s/profile/0053i000002mtr4AAA), Bongani Bila (/s/profile/005QO00000E2t1xYAB), and Ron CCIE#61935 (/s/profile/0056e00000DLbWdAAL) like this.

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Rajendran (/s/profile/0053i000002owOoAAI)

a month ago

Hi - The .ova and .qcow2 are x86-64 and not compatible for ARM (macbook -silicon). Anyone got a .ova or qcow2 image for ARM, if so, please upload them.

Thanks

Rajendran

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Dileep kumar JN (/s/profile/0056e00000FBtvBAAT)

published a new version of this Knowledge.

January 20, 2026 at 2:15 PM (/s/feed/0D5QO00001quhEw0AI)

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Akhila Pamukuntla (/s/profile/0053i0000039domAAA)

6 months ago

Hello all, apologize for the delay. The files should be up this week. Thanks for your patience.

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